ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

SOCIAL SCIENCES

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE D

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Geography (50) – latitude and longitude, word, line and ratio scales, map projections, a summer-rainfall climate table, ocean currents and deserts, urbanisation, site and situation, imports, exports and the balance of trade. Section B: History (50) – child labour and James Watt's steam engine, diamonds and the Kimberley Big Hole, De Beers and Cecil Rhodes, King Leopold's Congo, trench warfare and the sinking of the SS Mendi.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of TWO sections: SECTION A: Geography (50 marks) and SECTION B: History (50 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions in BOTH sections.
3. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
4. Read the sources carefully before you answer the questions on them. The sources were written for this examination and are based on historical facts.
5. Show ALL calculations. A non-programmable calculator may be used.

SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

QUESTION 1: MAPS AND GLOBES

1.1 Study the table of South African towns.

Town	Latitude	Longitude
Polokwane	23°54′S	29°27′E
Gqeberha	33°58′S	25°36′E
Upington	28°27′S	21°15′E

1.1.1 Which town is furthest south? (1)

1.1.2 Which town is furthest west? (1)

1.1.3 How many minutes are there in one degree? (1)

1.1.4 Which line of latitude (with a name) passes very close to Polokwane? (1)

1.2 Name the THREE types of scale and give an example of EACH. (3)

1.3 On a map with a scale of 1 : 50 000, two schools are 6 cm apart. Calculate the real distance between them in kilometres. (3)

1.4 On a Mercator map, Greenland looks almost as big as Africa, but Africa is about 14 times bigger. Explain why. (2)

1.5 Explain the difference between a large-scale map and a small-scale map. (2)

1.6 It is 10:00 at 0° (Greenwich). What is the sun time at 60°E? Show your working. (1)

[15]

QUESTION 2: CLIMATE

2.1 Study the climate data for Mbombela (Mpumalanga).

Month	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Rainfall (mm)	130	110	90	45	20	10	10	12	35	70	105	125
Temperature (°C)	25	25	24	21	18	15	15	17	20	22	23	24

2.1.1 Which month is the wettest? (1)

2.1.2 Is Mbombela in a summer-rainfall or a winter-rainfall region? Give a reason. (2)

2.1.3 Calculate the annual temperature range. (2)

2.1.4 Name ONE crop that is suited to this hot, wet summer climate. (1)

2.2 (a) Name the cold ocean current along the west coast of South Africa. (b) Explain how this current helps to cause the dry conditions of the Namib Desert. (4)

2.3 Give TWO ways in which plants are adapted to survive in a desert. (2)

2.4 Explain why places near the equator are hotter than places near the poles. (3)

2.5 Give TWO effects of drought on farmers. (2)

[17]

QUESTION 3: SETTLEMENT, TRANSPORT AND TRADE

3.1 What is urbanisation? (2)

3.2 Give TWO push factors that make people leave rural areas and TWO pull factors that attract them to cities. (4)

3.3 Explain the difference between the site and the situation of a settlement. (2)

3.4 Give TWO reasons why many early towns in South Africa were built next to rivers. (2)

3.5 (a) Explain the difference between imports and exports. (b) What is a favourable balance of trade? (4)

3.6 Name TWO products that South Africa exports. (2)

3.7 Why is road transport used more than rail transport to move goods in South Africa today? (2)

[18]

TOTAL SECTION A: [50]

SECTION B: HISTORY

QUESTION 4: THE INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION

Read Source A and answer the questions.

SOURCE A: Children in the cotton mills

In the early 1800s many children in Britain started working in cotton mills from the age of seven or eight. They worked twelve hours or more a day, six days a week. Small children were used to crawl under moving machines to clean them or tie broken threads. Overseers beat children who were slow or fell asleep. Many were injured, and few could go to school.

4.1 At what age did many children start working in the mills? (1)

4.2 How many hours a day did they work? (1)

4.3 Why were small children used to clean under the machines? (2)

4.4 Give TWO dangers that children faced in the mills, according to the source. (2)

4.5 Why did mill owners want to employ children? (2)

4.6 Explain why James Watt's improved steam engine was so important for the Industrial Revolution. (3)

4.7 Give TWO ways in which life in British towns changed during the Industrial Revolution. (2)

4.8 Would you agree that the Industrial Revolution brought only benefits to ordinary people? Explain. (2)

[15]

QUESTION 5: THE MINERAL REVOLUTION

Read Source B and answer the questions.

SOURCE B: The Big Hole

After diamonds were found at Colesberg Kopje in 1871, thousands of diggers rushed to the area. They dug by hand with picks and shovels, each on a small claim. The hill soon became a huge pit, later called the Big Hole of Kimberley. As the pit grew deeper, the sides collapsed and water flooded in, and only companies with money for steam pumps and machines could carry on. By 1888 Cecil John Rhodes had bought out his rivals and formed De Beers Consolidated Mines.

5.1 In which year were diamonds found at Colesberg Kopje? (1)

5.2 Which tools did the first diggers use? (1)

5.3 Give TWO problems that the diggers faced as the pit got deeper. (2)

5.4 Why could only companies with a lot of money continue mining? (2)

5.5 What is a monopoly? Explain how De Beers became a monopoly. (3)

5.6 Explain why pass laws were introduced for black workers on the diamond fields. (2)

5.7 Give TWO ways in which the discovery of diamonds changed South Africa. (2)

5.8 Why was diamond mining at Kimberley important for the later development of gold mining on the Witwatersrand? (2)

[15]

QUESTION 6: COLONIALISM AND THE FIRST WORLD WAR

Read Source C and answer the questions.

SOURCE C: King Leopold's Congo

From 1885 the Congo Free State was the private property of King Leopold II of Belgium. People were forced to collect wild rubber for his companies. Villages that did not collect enough rubber were punished: soldiers burnt homes, took women hostage and cut off people's hands. Missionaries and journalists sent photographs to Europe, and in 1908 Belgium was forced to take the Congo away from the king.

6.1 Who owned the Congo Free State from 1885? (1)

6.2 What were the people forced to collect? (1)

6.3 Give TWO punishments used against villages, according to the source. (2)

6.4 How did the world find out about what was happening in the Congo? (2)

6.5 Why did European countries want colonies in Africa? Give FOUR reasons. (4)

6.6 Describe THREE conditions that soldiers lived in in the trenches of the Western Front. (3)

6.7 Read Source D and answer the questions.

SOURCE D: The SS Mendi

Early on 21 February 1917, in thick fog in the English Channel, the troopship SS Mendi was hit by a larger ship, the SS Darro. More than 600 men of the South African Native Labour Corps died. They had volunteered to work in France, building roads and loading ships, but were not allowed to carry weapons. For many years their sacrifice was not honoured in South Africa.

6.7.1 When did the SS Mendi sink? (1)

6.7.2 What work had the men volunteered to do in France? (2)

6.7.3 Why do you think their sacrifice was not honoured in South Africa for many years? (2)

6.7.4 Suggest ONE way in which the men of the Mendi can be remembered today. (2)

[20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [50]

TOTAL: 100

www.academiccentral.co.za

END OF QUESTION PAPER